START

What is it?

A for-and-against essay is a formal argumentative text that presents both sides of a topic. You discuss arguments for and against, justify each idea, and give your own position only in the conclusion.

1. **INTRODUCTION**
   Present the topic in general. Do not give your opinion yet. Finish by signalling that there are arguments for and against.
2. **MAIN BODY · FOR**
   Use a separate paragraph with two advantages. Explain why each point matters.
3. **MAIN BODY · AGAINST**
   Use a separate paragraph with two disadvantages. Explain or exemplify each point.
4. **CONCLUSION**
   Summarise both sides and state your own justified opinion.

TASK 1

Build your essay map

Choose a topic and note two ideas for and two ideas against. Add a reason or example for every idea.

FOR	AGAINST

TOOLKIT

Connectors by purpose

INTRODUCE POINTS

one major advantage/disadvantage of · a further advantage · regarding · concerning

LIST POINTS

in the first place · first of all · to start with · firstly · secondly · finally · last but not least

ADD POINTS

what is more · furthermore · also · in addition · besides · apart from this · not to mention

CONTRAST

on the other hand · however · in spite of · while · nevertheless · despite · even though · although

EXAMPLES

for example · for instance · like · especially · such as · in particular

CONCLUDE

to sum up · all in all · all things considered · in conclusion · on the whole · taking everything into account

TASK 2

Connector challenge

Write one sentence about your chosen topic using a contrast connector and one using an example connector.

SAMPLE

Being your own boss

INTRODUCTION

Have you ever considered becoming your own boss? In recent years, the number of people starting their own business has risen significantly. Many claim this is because more people are no longer content to work for someone else.

FOR

One major advantage of being self-employed is that you are self-reliant and can make decisions on your own. This gives freedom and allows you to work without interference. What is more, you can plan your working day for your convenience. Finally, if the business succeeds, the credit is yours.

AGAINST

However, there are disadvantages. Building a successful business may require long hours and sacrifices in your personal life. Moreover, a government study found that over a quarter of businesses run by newly self-employed people failed within their first two years.

CONCLUSION

All things considered, self-employment can be gratifying, although it is not without difficulties. When success is achieved, the greatest reward is knowing that you have done it on your own.

TASK 3

Spot the language

Copy one connector from each main-body paragraph and explain its function.

FINAL TASK

From plan to paragraph

Write a for-and-against essay: 'Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of being your own boss.' Follow the four-part structure and use 150-180 words.

INTRODUCTION

FOR

AGAINST

CONCLUSION